Team 10: Sprint 4 Retrospective

Course: CS 4390/5388 Software Project Management
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Part 1: Team Retrospective (how we worked)

1. What went well as a team this sprint?

This sprint the team coordinated a lot more, focusing on the separation of tasks in a clearer way rather than each collaborating on everything at the same time.

2. What did not go well, or where did the team struggle?

The team struggled to set clear goals and communication could have been improved, especially since each member had their own tasks.

3. What caused the friction? (communication, unclear ownership, scope creep, external blockers, etc.)

Communication was a friction point, having clear tasks for each member meant that individual tasks came first. Finishing a task or section was not communicated, so decisions or changes were made later rather than earlier.

4. One concrete change the team commits to for Sprint 5:

Our team contributes to continue working, but focusing on keeping the team updated and communicating constantly throughout the sprint about updates, questions, suggestions and especially requesting help if time allows.

Part 2: Project Retrospective (what happened to the project)

1. What changed in the project this sprint? (scope, schedule, budget, risk, assumptions)

We added real reliability goals for the portal for the first time (two SLOs with error budgets, severity levels, and an incident review).

2. Decisions we made and why, including any we would make differently in hindsight:

We split the work by person (Service Levels doc, sketches, portal), so each part had a clear owner. But we used the Oct 20 broken-links incident for the blameless review because it was a real failure. In hindsight, we could have set an earlier internal deadline for the portal page instead of leaving the deploy for the last days.

3. Where the actual outcome differed from the plan, and by how much:

The Service Levels doc and the sketches got done, but each user had a different interpretation of the application itself. Lack of communication forced us to push things to later in the week rather than earlier.

4. What this means for how we plan Sprint 5:

We will set a clear timeline and deadline for things to get going and will have designated people message on the board throughout the week to force communication for the team should necessary.